CLASS 8 — ENGLISH GULMOHAR · HARD LEVEL CHAPTER TEST SET 2

Chapter 5: **The Rock and the Sea** | RBSE Pattern | Session 2026–27

Time: 1 Hour 30 Minutes Name: _____ Roll No.: _____ **Maximum Marks: 40**

General Instructions:

1. All questions are compulsory.
2. Q. 1–10 are Objective Type (1 mark each).
3. Q. 11–14 are Very Short Answer Type (2 marks each).
4. Q. 15–18 are Short Answer Type (3 marks each).
5. Q. 19–20 are Long Answer Type (5 marks each).
6. Internal choice is given in Q. 17 to 20.
7. Write the question number before each answer.
8. Hard level: application and higher-order questions.

SECTION — A (Objective Type Questions) 10 × 1 = 10

Choose the correct option and write it in your answer book.

1. The poet's view of strength seems to be that: 1

(a) strength is only hardness
(b) strength is noise
(c) lasting strength lies in patience, not rigidity
(d) weakness always wins

2. Reading 'placed by fate', the Rock's claim could be doubted because: 1

(a) seas never reach land **(b)** rocks never move
(c) fate is unknown **(d)** nothing in nature is permanent

3. The phrase 'a game' for the Sea's work on cliffs implies that the Sea: 1

(a) is cruel on purpose **(b)** feels no strain
(c) is tired **(d)** is afraid

4. Which pair shows irony in the poem? 1

(a) The Sea is wet **(b)** The Rock is large
(c) The hard Rock is worn away by soft water **(d)** The Sea is blue

5. The poet's choice of two speakers rather than one narrator makes the poem more: 1

(a) technical **(b)** silent **(c)** factual **(d)** dramatic

6. Which statement best compares the two speakers? 1

(a) The Rock relies on resistance, the Sea on patient time
(b) Both are equally proud
(c) Both are afraid
(d) The Sea is weaker

7. The word 'withstand' implies: 1

(a) to run away **(b)** to join
(c) to praise **(d)** to resist and endure

8. The best title alternative would be: 1

(a) Strength and Change **(b)** A Day at the Beach
(c) The Fisherman **(d)** Mountains of Salt

9. The poem implies that stubborn pride is: 1

(a) admirable **(b)** ultimately foolish
(c) always rewarded **(d)** a safe policy

10. 'Wear down' is closest in meaning to: 1

(a) erode **(b)** colour **(c)** polish **(d)** lift

SECTION — B (Very Short Answer Type) 4 × 2 = 8

Answer in about 20–30 words each.

11. What does the poem suggest about strength and pride? 2

12. Suggest an alternative title and justify it. 2

13. What does the Sea's phrase about continents add to the argument? 2

14. How can the poem be read as a comment on human life? 2

SECTION — C (Short Answer Type) 4 × 3 = 12

Answer in about 40–60 words each.

15. Analyse the Sea's use of time-related ideas in stanza 3. 3

16. Evaluate the poem's ending for its message. 3

17. Interpret the line of thought that mountains rise from the Sea. 3

OR

Explain the ironic effect of calling the destruction of cliffs a 'game'. 3

18. How does the poet use contrast in imagery (hard / soft)? 3

OR

Discuss the role of tone in conveying the poem's message. 3

SECTION — D (Long Answer Type) 2 × 5 = 10

Answer in about 100–150 words each.

19. Compare the Rock and the Sea as symbols and show how the poet uses them to argue a point. 5

OR

How does the poem use irony and contrast to teach a moral? 5

20. Write an article (about 150 words) titled 'Why Change is the Only Constant', using the poem. 5

OR

Write a diary entry of the Rock after hearing the Sea's reply. 5

END OF QUESTION PAPER Total: 40 Marks

MASTERMIND